

Geoff — before we go further with Kartlos

TO Geoffrey Cockrill
FROM Jubhele and Mpho
RE The next step in Amu's career — the Kartlos Rukhaia / Sports Consulting Management offer, FC Orbi
BEFORE The 13 July 2026 deposit decision

THANK YOU, FIRST

Before anything else in this note — thank you. You got Amu to a point neither of us could have gotten him to alone, and that doesn't get said enough in the middle of paperwork and deadlines.

What we're about to ask isn't us pulling back from that. It's the opposite — we're ready to move forward, we've already put real money and time behind this, and we want it to work. But handing Amu's day-to-day football life to someone in a country we've never been to is a bigger step than anything so far, and we want to take it with our eyes open, the same way you would if he were your own son. This note is us putting in writing what we'd like to understand and agree before we do.

WHAT WE'RE HOPING FOR

SHARED GROUND

We think you want the same thing we do

Amu is 18. What happens to him over the next year or two matters more than almost anything else in his career, and we'd rather get it right than get it fast.

A club and an agent that make him better — real minutes, real experience, the right level for where he actually is right now

not

A signature, a fee, and a name added to someone's roster

WHAT WE'D LOVE YOUR READ ON

You know Kartlos better than we do. Here's what would help us most, in your own words.

His track record with players like Amu

DEVELOPMENT

The best sign of what he'll do for Amu is what he's actually done for others before him.

- ② In the last five years, who has he taken from Amu's age and level through to regular first-team football — could we get names and clubs?

- ② What happened to the ones who didn't make it — did he stay involved and help them find another club, or did they drop off his books?

What happens if the minutes don't come

PRIORITY #1

This is genuinely our top priority for Amu right now — game time over a rushed contract. The real test is what an agent does when a placement isn't delivering that.

- ② If Amu is stuck on the bench for two or three months, what would Kartlos actually do — go looking for a better fit, or leave him there?

- ② Can he point to a player he's moved out of a bad situation into a better one, not just placed once and left?

MAKING SURE YOU'RE TAKEN CARE OF

This next part isn't a question — it's a principle we want to state plainly. You've earned to be paid properly for the work that got Amu here and for brokering this move. We don't want that sitting as an informal arrangement on the side, unspoken and easy to shortchange. We'd like to agree a fair figure together and write it into the deal as its own explicit line — done right, on paper, the same as everything else in this agreement.

And separately: are you staying involved as someone Amu can still call after the handover, or is this your last active role in his career? Either is fine with us — we just want to know, so we can plan around it, and so whatever you're paid reflects which one it actually is.

WHY THERE'S NO NEED TO RUSH

One thing worth saying plainly, following on from what we've already discussed with you directly: we've decided to extend Amu's stay in Georgia to 6+ months, and that decision came before this contract conversation with Kartlos — it isn't a reaction to the offer, and it isn't us scrambling to fit a decision around a flight. We're covering the change fee ourselves.

The thinking is bigger than FC Orbi. We'd like Georgia to be his base for a while — somewhere he can train and live from, while exploring other playing opportunities across the region that don't require getting on a plane every time. Armenia and Turkey are both genuinely reachable overland

from where he'll be, which opens up real options if FC Orbi isn't the right fit, without needing a new flight and a new visa process each time.

So there's no clock forcing our hand on Kartlos specifically. We'd rather take the time to get this right — verify what needs verifying, agree terms properly — than sign something quickly just because he happens to already be in the country.

THE STRUCTURE WE'D LIKE TO PROPOSE

This came up faster than we expected — Amu's current programme ends next weekend, just a few days before month-end — so here's what we'd like to put to Kartlos given the timing: split the €13,500 into two payments instead of one lump sum up front, with nothing due before either date.

PAYMENT	WHEN	AMOUNT
First half	End of July 2026	€6,750
Second half	End of August 2026	€6,750

Why this timing actually matters: if Kartlos agrees to it, he's taking Amu in and caring for him — housing, training, day-to-day — from right after this programme ends through to the very first payment, weeks later, without having received a cent yet. That's real risk carried in good faith, before any money changes hands. An agent genuinely focused on developing Amu can accept that. One who's only there for the fee usually can't — and that alone would tell us something worth knowing before we commit further.

And so it's fair to Kartlos too, not just a test of him: we're committing Amu to full training attendance, fitness, and discipline through this same period. If he holds up his side and things still don't come together, that tells us plainly where the problem actually lies — and we'd genuinely value your help keeping him honest to it, since you know him better than anyone taking this over will.

LOOKING OUT FOR HIM DAY TO DAY

Amu will be alone in a country neither of us has visited. We'd love your thoughts on who arranges and actually checks in on housing and food in person, what the plan is if he's unwell, injured, or in crisis, and whether there's room for him to keep some form of study going alongside football — not because we doubt this move, but because he's 18 and football is only part of what has to go right.

WHAT WOULD HELP US MOVE FORWARD

None of this is a condition on trusting you — it's what would let us say yes to this with real confidence, for Amu's sake.

- ✓ The milestone-based structure above, agreed with Kartlos, in writing
- ✓ Your own compensation agreed as a fair figure and written into the deal as its own line
- ✓ A named, reachable contact in Georgia we can call directly — not only through Kartlos
- ✓ A plan for what happens if Amu isn't playing meaningful minutes within an agreed window
- ✓ Room for us to independently check Kartlos's FIFA agent license and speak to the players he's placed abroad before

FOR FULL TRANSPARENCY

One more thing we don't want to do quietly on the side: we've also put together our own written thinking on this whole opportunity — not to spring it on anyone, but because a decision this size deserves to be looked at properly, and we'd rather show you all of it than summarize it down to something that leaves things out. So here it is, in full, below.

It reads a little more like careful analysis than the rest of this letter, because that's what it's for — please don't take the tone of it as a judgment on you. Nothing in it changes anything we've already said above; if anything, it's the thinking that got us to what we've already asked for.

Our honest bottom line

Both FC Orbi and Sports Consulting Management check out as real — that already puts this ahead of the outright scams we read about while looking into this. But the fee structure, the way all the financial risk currently sits on Amu's side, and the size of the fee relative to the wage on offer match a pattern player unions and journalists have kept documenting right through 2025, across the same landscape South African, Ghanaian and Nigerian families keep losing money in. We want to be clear: none of that means this is a scam. It means it's exactly the kind of deal that deserves real verification before more money moves — which is what the rest of this is.

What checks out

FC Orbi

The club

- ② Confirmed on Transfermarkt and Soccerway — currently 5th in Georgian Liga 3 (third tier), matching the standings table we were shown
- ② 20-man squad, average age 24.8, already 3 foreign players (15% of the squad) registered this season — worth reconciling with the "one quota spot left" pitch
- ② 2,000-seat Grigol Jomartidze Stadium — a real but modest lower-league ground

- ❓ Liga 3 is explicitly the amateur-to-professional bridge division in Georgia, not a fully professional league

Sports Consulting Management

Kartlos's agency

- ❓ Has an actual Transfermarkt agent profile — not a ghost operation
- ❓ Represents 7 players total, combined market value €250,000 — a very small book
- ❓ Clients placed in Georgian lower-tier and regional clubs; no record of a placement into a major European league
- ❓ Two prior foreign clients: a Ghanaian midfielder (Blessing Assamoah, now in Erovnuli Liga 2) and a Nigerian forward (Francis Anyanwu, last at FC Telavi in the actual top flight) who's currently without a club

What we found reading the contract itself

All the monetary risk in the agreement as written currently runs one direction, so this is the part we'd most love your read on:

The deposit and second payment are non-refundable no matter what happens. If the 31 July payment is even a day late, the representation agreement ends immediately and everything paid so far — including the deposit — stays with the agency, no matter the reason. That's the single biggest thing we'd want changed before anything more moves, and it's the main thinking behind the two-payment structure we proposed above.

A few more things worth putting plainly:

- ❓ The economics don't clear for years: €13,500 total against wages of about €170/month. Over the full possible 12 months, that's roughly €2,040 in wages against a €13,500 fee — not a percentage of a real transfer or salary, but a flat charge that dwarfs anything Amu actually earns from the arrangement itself.
- ❓ If the September payment is late, the current wording doesn't cancel the deal either — it lets the club push him to the reserve/B team indefinitely and "suspend" representation, with no refund and no clean exit. We'd like a real, mutual exit clause instead.
- ❓ We're planning to cover Amu's accommodation ourselves regardless of how the fee conversation lands — it doesn't change what's owed to Kartlos on paper, but it means we, not the club or agency, control where he actually lives.
- ❓ A player covering his own agent's fee is allowed under FIFA's rules, so this isn't unusual on that front by itself. What we'd love an honest answer on is the size of it: how much of the €13,500 is Kartlos's

own commission, versus costs passed through on the club's behalf?

Being "listed on Transfermarkt" gets mentioned as a selling point in places, but those listings can be added by any volunteer editor for almost any registered lower-league player — worth knowing it doesn't really confirm anything about career prospects on its own.

One thing we want to confirm directly rather than assume: FC Orbi's home ground is actually listed in Khashuri, about 90–100km from Tbilisi — not the capital, which is what a lot of our other research below assumed. Before anything else moves forward, we'd genuinely love to know plainly: will he actually be living and training in Khashuri, Tbilisi, or somewhere else, day to day?

And on the "B team now, first team later" framing: Georgian reserve teams are structurally required to play in a lower division than the first team, so if that's the real plan, it likely means Liga 4 or the Regionuli Liga rather than a depth squad in the same league Amu would already be starting in. Since showing him off is such a big part of why we're doing this at all, and that level has essentially no video coverage, we'd love clarity on two things: does FC Orbi even have a registered B team, and if the plan changes, which division would he actually be playing in?

For reference, the payment schedule as currently written: €4,000 deposit before 13 Jul 2026; €4,750 by 31 Jul 2026 (agreement terminates and the deposit is forfeited if late); €4,750 by 30 Sep 2026 (reserve/B-team demotion if late). This is what our two-payment proposal above is meant to replace.

How this compares to other paths into European football

ROUTE	UPFRONT COST	MONTHLY PAY	WHAT'S PROMISED
This deal — FC Orbi / SCM	€13,500	~€170	Guaranteed registration, forfeitable on late payment
Short EU trial/showcase camp (1–4 wks)	€395–2,000	None	Training + scout exposure, no contract guarantee — a service, not an outcome
Full residential academy, e.g. Spain Rush-SPF	~€35,000	None	Residential training, academics, organized trials — safer structure, but over 2.5x the cost
The fake-agent economy (documented cases, 2023–2025)	\$300–5,000+	Fabricated	Trials or contracts at name-brand clubs — money and "agent" vanish before or after arrival

What the data on paid placements actually says

No agency — legitimate or otherwise — publishes an audited success rate for turning a paid placement into a sustained career. The closest real numbers come from a FIFPRO Africa survey of 263 professional players on their experience with agents claiming to arrange moves abroad:



never received the trial they were promised

didn't get the contract they expected, even after a trial happened

SCM's only other African clients on record is currently without a club

What we'd like to verify before the next payment

All of this costs nothing and takes days, not weeks:

- ① Look up Kartlos on FIFA's own agent register (agents.fifa.com) rather than take the agency's word on license status
- ① Contact FC Orbi directly through the Georgian Football Federation, not through Kartlos or yourself, and confirm they know of this signing independently
- ① Get the club to confirm the current foreign-player quota status in writing, given 3 foreign players already appear on the registered squad
- ① See the actual player employment contract with FC Orbi — the fee agreement is with the agency only, and the club-side contract is a separate document worth reviewing on its own
- ① Have a lawyer look specifically at the forfeiture clause and confirm whether it's enforceable as written or negotiable
- ① Any further payment goes through a traceable channel with a receipt referencing this specific contract, never an informal transfer

None of this means we think it's necessarily a bad deal. FC Orbi and the agency both check out as real, which is more than most of the cautionary stories out there can say. It's just that "real entities" and "fair deal" are two different questions, and the second one is worth being thorough about.

Other routes and people we looked into

We want to be upfront that we looked well beyond just this one offer — not because we're set on going elsewhere, but because we wanted to actually know what else exists before saying yes to this one.

Going direct, with no agent at all: a player is always free to approach and negotiate with a club directly under FIFA's own rules — an agent is a service you can buy, not a requirement. Amu already has the biggest advantage that playbook depends on: he's physically in Georgia, training, and visible. A tight highlight reel, a one-page CV, and direct outreach to coaching staff at other Liga 3/Liga 2 clubs costs nothing and can run in parallel with FC Orbi.

Two more established Tbilisi agencies turned up, for context on what a bigger book looks like: FA Players Agents (Republic Square, Tbilisi, +995 577 311777, info@playersagents.ge — 23 players, 12 in the Georgian top flight, €19.18m combined value) and Free Football (lv. Kereselidze 1, Tbilisi, +995 598 444888, info@freefootball.ge — 27 players, 15 top-flight, €32.13m). Both a

different scale to SCM entirely, though it's not established either takes on completely unattached trialists the way SCM does — worth a direct call to ask.

SCM's own two foreign placements are honestly the closest real reference point we have for what Kartlos actually delivers: Blessing Assamoah (Ghana), now at Erovnuli Liga 2 — one level above where Amu would start — and Francis Anyanwu (Nigeria), who reached FC Telavi in the actual top flight before it was relegated in 2025, and is currently without a club. We'd love to reach either of them, ideally through their clubs directly or through GEFA (the Georgian Footballers' Association, a FIFPRO-affiliated players' union) rather than through Kartlos or yourself.

FIFA-licensed South African agents are also worth a call, since their fees are capped and tied to an actual signed transaction rather than a large deposit paid up front: Ryan Hartslielief at Bigtime Sports Academy (FIFA licence via SAFA), Karabo Mathang-Tshabuse at P Management, and Mike Makaab at ProSport International in Durban. These agents typically work with players already inside academy structures, so fit isn't guaranteed, but a genuine licensed agent should take an introductory call without asking for a non-refundable deposit first.

A no-fee alternative worth knowing about: former Bafana Bafana defender Mark Fish's foundation has a standing partnership with English Championship club Charlton Athletic to assess South African youth players at the club's own academy — the club evaluates for free, the foundation funds logistics, and there's no forfeiture clause because no money changes hands up front.

And on the pricier end, Spain Rush-SPF in Valencia is a genuine, longer-running version of the "training and exposure, no guarantee" model — residential academy since 2016, 500+ alumni, South Africa specifically named as a source country, real named partner clubs. Trials run 2 weeks to 3 months with no guaranteed contract sold. Pricing is roughly €35,000 though, well over double this deal — not a cheaper alternative, a different and much larger commitment.

What actually governs a foreign signing in Georgian football

No public, official squad-quota number for Liga 3 turned up in our research, so we'd treat the "only one quota spot left" pitch as unverified rather than false. Worth asking directly: is Amunene actually being registered with the GFF as a professional foreign player, or would he train and play informally, unregistered? And could we get an itemized breakdown of the €13,500 — how much is commission versus costs passed through on the club's behalf?

What daily life actually looks like

Cost of living

Generally favorable

⌚ \$1,000–1,500/month covers a comfortable single-person budget

⌚ 1-bedroom rent roughly \$400–700/month depending on district

⌚ Budget meals \$3–8, mid-range dining \$8–20

Something we can't not mention

Documented, specific to Black and South Asian foreigners

- ⌚ Verbal and physical abuse of African and Asian nationals has been reported in public places, transport, and rental housing
- ⌚ 2015: two Nigerian nationals attacked on Tbilisi's Rustaveli Avenue by a hooligan group, filmed and posted online
- ⌚ 2018: foreign students, targeted for their color, assaulted and forced out of a municipal stadium

We're not raising this to alarm anyone — hate-crime prosecutions have reportedly increased and this is a different question from "is Georgia dangerous" generally. It's specifically about how a young Black South African is likely to be treated day to day, and it's the reason we'd love to be put in touch with one of FC Orbi's existing foreign players directly, independent of Kartlos or yourself, as a real reference point.

Season timing

The 2026 Georgian season runs 28 February to 6 December. We'd love the exact date Amunene must be registered by to play competitively this season, and written confirmation his registration will actually be filed with GFF — plus the honest arithmetic on what "six months, possibly plus six more" buys, since a term starting around August runs into the December season close almost immediately, meaning a chunk of any extension would sit inside the January/February off-season rather than on the pitch.

The specific terms we'd like to change

The single thing worth restructuring above everything else: right now the agreement pays out in full whether or not Amu ever gets on the pitch. Here's the shape of what we'd like to propose instead, as a starting point for discussion:

AS CURRENTLY WRITTEN	WHAT WE'D ASK FOR INSTEAD
Deposit + 2nd payment fully earned regardless of outcome	Final tranche released only after registration <i>and</i> a defined number of competitive appearances
No trial — straight into a signed 6-month term	A 2–4 week club-assessed trial before the bulk of the payment is due
Exclusivity to FC Orbi in force from day one	Exclusivity starts only once he's appeared in a defined number of competitive matches

AS CURRENTLY WRITTEN	WHAT WE'D ASK FOR INSTEAD
Missed 3rd payment → demotion, agency can suspend services — all downside on Amu	A mutual exit: zero competitive appearances within 6 weeks of registration, despite full fitness, lets us exit with a pro-rated refund
Terms summarized only inside the agency's fee agreement	We see and countersign the actual GFF-registered player-club employment contract before the final payment

On defining "appearance" itself, we'd love something concrete — a minimum number of minutes across a set share of matchday squads over the first two months — rather than just "squad member," which can be satisfied by dressing him without ever playing him.

The fuller version of the milestone structure

We covered our actual live proposal above — the two-payment split and what Amu commits to on his side. For completeness, here's the fuller four-gate version that thinking is built on, in case there's ever room to negotiate this more detailed structure instead:

MILESTONE	WHAT HAS TO HAPPEN	RELEASED
0. Trial confirmed	FC Orbi issues short written confirmation of trial terms and intent to register, direct to us	€0
1. GFF registration	Officially registered as a professional foreign player, itemized fee breakdown provided	€4,000
2. First squad inclusion	Named in an official matchday squad for a competitive fixture	€2,375
3. Real playing time	Minimum 45 minutes played in at least 3 of the next 6 competitive fixtures	€2,375
4. Extension offered	FC Orbi formally offers the optional second 6-month term in writing	€4,750

One more non-negotiable either way, since the actual goal is showcasing him, not just playing him: footage. Georgian Liga 3 has thin video coverage and the lower tiers have essentially none, so we'll have someone film every match from the stands — a phone on a tripod is enough. That footage becomes the highlight reel for the direct-outreach option above, regardless of how FC Orbi plays out.

The fuller detail behind the Georgia-base plan

We touched on this above already — Armenia and Turkey being genuinely reachable by public transport. Here's the fuller detail behind that:

OPTION	VISA (SA PASSPORT)	GETTING THERE
Other Georgian clubs	None needed — already resident	N/A — lowest-friction option of all
Armenia	e-Visa, up to 120 days	Bus/marshrutka from Tbilisi, ~16 departures/day, 4–7 hrs, \$8–30; overnight train also runs
Turkey	e-Visa, ~30-day stays	Land border at Sarpi near Batumi — cross on foot, then local bus into Batumi in under an hour. Direct buses already run Tbilisi–Istanbul via this crossing
Azerbaijan	e-Visa required, not visa-free	Unsettled — a Tbilisi–Baku train resumed recently but access for foreign e-visa holders and the land border were both still restricted as of our last check. Don't rely on this one without confirming directly first
Cyprus	Visa required, 2–6 week processing	Flight only — it's an island, there's no overland option, ever

How we'll keep track, going forward



Gate 0

GFF registration confirmed

Written confirmation from the club, not the agency, before any further payment.



Week 2–4

First matchday squad inclusion?

Checked directly against the club's own squad list or GFF/Soccerway match reports.



Week 6

Red-flag checkpoint

Zero competitive minutes by here, despite full fitness, is our trigger point to revisit the placement — not to leave Georgia, just to start looking seriously at other options from the same base.



Monthly

Written status update

A named club contact, not the agency, for a short note on appearances, minutes, injuries, and disciplinary status.

You may end up being the natural person we go through for some of these questions with Kartlos, and we're genuinely fine with that. But we'd still love to sit down with you directly, in person or on a call, once we all feel like we're seeing eye to eye — everything above is how we get there, not a

replacement for that conversation. And happy to share our full source list for any of this if it's ever useful.

We're grateful for everything you've already put into Amu's football — this is us wanting to get the next part right, together with you, not around you. Happy to sit down and talk through any of this whenever suits you this week.

**With thanks,
Jubhele and Mpho**

A personal note, not a legal document. The milestone figures and terms above are a proposal for discussion, to be confirmed in writing with Kartlos and Sports Consulting Management before any further payment.